

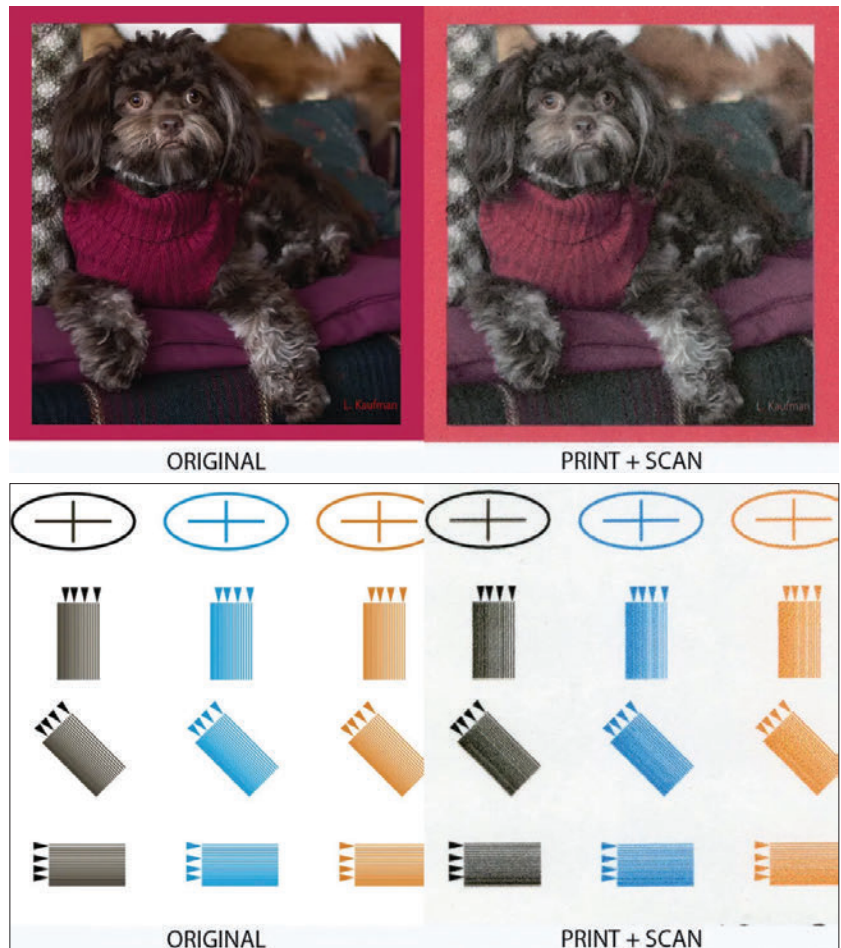
out the moving bits inside the printer. Most printers in this range come with Nylon or Delrin gears and these erode much faster than metal. So expect a life of 3-to-5 years which is the usual fare for most home printers. The DeskJet 4388 can handle bursts of use, but it is not the right machine for a desk that prints hundreds of pages every week. Replacement cartridges are HP 683 black and HP 683 tri-colour, and the box includes HP 683 setup black and tri-colour cartridges.

Features

The HP DeskJet 4388's feature set is more complete than its compact price positioning might suggest. The main attraction is the combination of Wi-Fi, USB and ADF support in a relatively inexpensive colour inkjet. For households and small offices that still print forms, school work, ID copies, invoices, homework sheets and occasional colour pages, the HP DeskJet 4388 becomes a great option.

The control panel is basic, but usable. The LCD display shows copy count, wireless status, Wi-Fi Direct status, warnings, errors and estimated ink levels. The buttons cover power, cancel, resume, Wi-Fi, information, colour copy and black copy. You're getting a decent amount of information from the display, but users will still depend on the HP app or software for more complex actions. Many inexpensive all-in-one printers force users to scan or copy one sheet at a time on the flatbed. The DeskJet 4388's ADF makes multi-page copying and scanning less tedious, especially for office forms, school documents and receipts. We found that the ADF worked reliably. It fed pages properly, did not introduce obvious skewing and did not become a weak point in daily use.

The printer also supports Wi-Fi Direct, allowing a device to connect directly to the printer without joining an existing network. Unlike Ethernet wherein hundreds of people can connect to a printer at any given time, Wi-Fi Direct is more limited. HP's guide notes



that up to five computers or mobile devices can connect using Wi-Fi Direct which is more than appropriate for a home / SOHO printer. You're not going to be getting low-duty printers if you had the need to connect hundreds of users to one printer in the first place.

There are also a few practical maintenance and reporting features available from the control panel. The information button can print a printer information page, while specific button combinations can print Wi-Fi test reports, network configuration pages, Wi-Fi Direct guides, Web Services reports and WPS PIN pages. These may not be glamorous features, but they are genuinely useful when the printer has to be set up in a home network where router, phone and laptop aren't always behaving nicely.

HP's dynamic security implementation means the printer is intended to

work only with cartridges that have new or reused HP electronic circuitry. The web page for this printer states that periodic firmware updates will be delivered over the internet to maintain dynamic security and block cartridges using modified or non-HP circuitry. This is part of one of the many steps that HP takes to stem the use of cheaper third-party cartridges.

Software

The HP app sits at the centre of the DeskJet 4388 experience. It is used for setup, printer management, status checks, printing, scanning and supplies management. It's nice to have one app as the tool for everything. **d**

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